(Goth. **þeihan**), *to thrive*; sing. gen. **fēos, plēos,** beside nom. **feoh,** *cattle, property,* **pleoh,** *danger*; pl. nom. **hēa** from ***hēahe,** beside sing. **hēah,** *high.* In Anglian loss of **h** and contraction took place earlier than the syncope of **i(e)**, as **flīþ** from ***flīhiþ,** *he flees,* **fēþ,** *he seizes,* **sīs(t)** from ***sihis,** *thou seest,* **sīþ** from ***sihiþ,** *he sees,* **hēsta** from ***hēhista,** *highest,* **nēsta** from ***nēhista,** *nearest,* beside WS. **flīehþ, fēhþ, siehst, siehþ, hīehsta, nīehsta.**

ACCIDENCE

CHAPTER XI

NOUNS

§ **330.** In OE. as in the oldest periods of the other Germanic languages, nouns are divided into two great classes, according as the stem originally ended in a vowel or a consonant, cp. the similar division of nouns in Sanskrit, Latin and Greek. Nouns whose stems originally ended in a vowel belong to the vocalic or so-called strong declension. Those whose stems originally ended in **-n** belong to the weak declension. All other consonantal stems will be put together under the general heading, 'Minor Declensions.'

§ **331.** Owing to the loss of final short vowels, and consonants, in prehistoric OE. (§§ **211–16**), several different kinds of stems regularly fell together in the nom. and acc. singular, so that, from the point of view of OE., the nom. and acc. singular end in consonants, and we are only able to classify such stems either by starting out from prim. Germanic, or from the plural, or from a comparison with the other old Germanic languages; thus the OE. nom. and acc. singular of **dæg,** *day*; **word,** *word*; **dǣl,** *part*; **hand,** *hand*; **lamb,** *lamb*, correspond to prim. Germanic ***đaȝaz, *đaȝan,** older **-os, -om**; ***wurđan,** older **-om**; ***đailiz, *đailin,** older **-is, -im**; ***χanđuz** (Goth. **handus**), ***χanđun** (Goth. **handu**), older **-us, -um**; ***lamƀaz,** older **-os** (cp. Lat. **genus,** gen. **generis**). The original distinction between the nom. and acc. singular of masculine and feminine nouns had disappeared in the oldest period of the English lan-

guage except in the **ō-** and the **n-**stems. And the original distinction between the nom. and acc. plural of masculine and feminine nouns had also disappeared, as nom. acc. **dagas,** *days,* **ēste,** *favours,* **suna,** *sons,* but Goth. nom. **dagōs, ansteis, sunjus;** acc. **dagans, anstins, sununs;** **guman,** *men,* prim. Germanic nom. ***ȝumaniz,** acc. ***ȝumanunz;** **fēt,** *feet,* prim. Germanic nom. ***fōtiz,** acc. Goth. **fotuns.** In like manner the original case endings of the **n-**stems, with the exception of the nom. singular and the gen. and dat. plural, had also disappeared in the oldest English, so that the element which originally formed part of the stem came to be regarded as a case ending (§§ **211–15**), cp. the similar process in the plural of the neuter **-os-**stems (§§ **419–20**). Before attempting the OE. declensions from a philological point of view, the student should master the chapter on the vowels of unaccented syllables, because it is impossible to restate in this chapter all the details dealt with there.

§ **332.** OE. nouns have two numbers: singular and plural; three genders: masculine, feminine, and neuter, as in the other old Germanic languages from which the gender of nouns in OE. does not materially differ; five cases: Nominative, Accusative, Genitive, Dative, and Instrumental. The dat. is generally used for the instr. in OE., so that this case is omitted in the paradigms, see § **334,** Note. The vocative is like the nominative. The nom. and acc. plural are always alike; in those declensions which would regularly have different forms for the nom. and acc., the acc. disappeared and the nom. was used in its stead. Traces of an old locative occur in what is called the uninflected dat. singular of **hām,** *home.* In Northumbrian both the declension and gender of nouns fluctuated considerably as compared with the other OE. dialects.

A. The Vocalic or Strong Declension.

1. The a-declension.

§ **333.** The **a**-declension comprises masculine and neuter nouns only, and corresponds to the Latin and Greek **o**-declension (Lat. masc. **-us,** neut. **-um,** Gr. -ος, -ον), for which reason it is sometimes called the **o**-declension. The **a**-declension is divided into pure **a**-stems, **ja**-stems, and **wa**-stems.

a. Pure a-stems.

§ **334.** *Masculine.*

Sing.			
Nom. Acc.	**stān,** *stone*	**dæg,** *day*	**mearh,** *horse*
Gen.	**stānes**	**dæges**	**mēares**
Dat.	**stāne**	**dæge**	**mēare**
Plur.			
Nom. Acc.	**stānas**	**dagas**	**mēaras**
Gen.	**stāna**	**daga**	**mēara**
Dat.	**stānum**	**dagum**	**mēarum**

Note.—The gen. sing. ended in **-æs** in the oldest period of the language, and in late OE. occasionally in **-as, -ys.** The oldest ending of the dat. sing. is **-æ.** The dat. sing. is generally used for the instrumental, so that this case is omitted in the paradigms. In the oldest period of the language the instrumental (originally a locative) ended in **-i,** later **-y,** and corresponded to the Gr. loc. ending οἴκ-ει, *at home,* not to οἴκ-οι which would have become **-e** in OE. as in the dat. (§ **217**). In late OE. the dat. pl. ended in **-un, -on, -an** (§ **284**).

The prim. Germanic forms of **dæg** were: Sing. nom. ***đaȝaz,** acc. ***đaȝan,** gen. ***đaȝesa** or ***đaȝasa** (with pronominal ending, § **465**), dat. ***đaȝai,** instr. ***đaȝī;** Plural nom. ***đaȝōz** (cp. Goth. **dagōs**), acc. ***đaȝanz** (cp. Goth. **dagans**), gen. ***đaȝõn** (cp. Gr. θεῶν, *of gods*), dat. ***đaȝomiz.**

From what has been said in chapter VI on the vowels of unaccented syllables it will be seen that all the forms of the singular and plural, except the nom. acc. pl., are regularly developed from the corresponding prim. Germanic forms. The pl. ending **-as**, OS. **-os**, **-as**, beside OHG. **-a**, has never been satisfactorily explained. The most probable explanation is that it represents the ending of nouns which originally had the accent on the ending like Skr. **gharmás**, *heat* = Gr. θερμός, *hot*, and that this ending then came to be used also for nouns which originally had the accent on the stem. That some nouns had the accent on the ending in prim. Germanic is proved by such words as OE. **cēosan**, *to choose*, beside **cyre** from ***kuzís** (§ 252), *choice*, which at a later period shifted the accent and dropped the final **-s** (? **-z**) after the analogy of nouns which originally had the accent on the stem. Upon this supposition the ending **-as** would regularly correspond to prim. Germanic pl. nom. **-ṓs** or acc. **-áns**. In like manner is to be explained the retention of the final **-s** in the second pers. sing. of the present tense of strong verbs in the West Germanic languages, cp. OE. **nimes(t)**, OS. OHG. **nimis**, beside Goth. **nimis**, *thou takest* (§ 476). The usual explanation that **-as** corresponds to an early Aryan double plural ending **-āsas** from older **-ōses** with **-es** from the consonant stems, is not in accordance with our present knowledge of the history of short vowels in final syllables in the oldest period of the various Germanic languages. An original ending **-ōses** would have become **-or** in OE.

§ **335.** Like **stān** are declined by far the greater majority of monosyllabic **a**-stems, as **ǣl**, *eel*; **ād**, *funeral pile*; **āþ**, *oath*; **bæst**, *bast*; **bār**, *boar*; **bāt**, *boat*; **bēag**, *ring*, *bracelet*; **bēam**, *tree*; **beard**, *beard*; **bearm**, *bosom*; **bēod**, *table*; **beorg**, *hill*; **beorn**, *warrior*; **bōg**, *bough*; **bolt**, *bolt*; **borg**, *pledge*; **brǣþ**, *odour*; **brand**, *firebrand*; **brōm**, *broom* (*the plant*); **būc**, *stomach*; **camb**, *comb*; **cēac**, *jug*; **cēap**,

price; **cēol**, *ship*; **ceorl**, *churl*; **clām** (NE. dial. **cloam**), *mud*; **clāþ**, *cloth*; **clūt**, *patch*; **cniht**, *boy*; **cræft**, *skill, strength*; **cwealm**, *death*; **dōm**, *doom*; **drēam**, *joy, revelry*; **dweorg**, *dwarf*; **earm**, *arm*; **earn**, *eagle*; **eorl**, *nobleman*; **fisc**, *fish*; **flēam**, *flight*; **forsc**, *frog*; **forst**, *frost*; **fox**, *fox*; **gang**, *going*; **gāst**, *spirit*; **gēac**, *cuckoo*; **geard**, *yard*; **gielp**, *boasting*; **hæft**, *captive*; **hām**, *home*; **healm**, *haulm*; **heals**, *neck*; **helm**, *helmet*; **hlæst**, *burden*; **hlāf**, *loaf*; **hōf**, *hoof*; **hrēam**, *cry, shout, uproar*; **hrīm**, *rime*; **hring**, *ring*; **hund**, *dog*; **hwelp**, *whelp*; **lāst**, *footprint*; **mæst**, *mast*; **mōr**, *moor*; **mūþ**, *mouth*; **rāp**, *rope*; **rūm**, *room*; **sceaft**, *shaft*; **sēam**, *seam*; **stōl**, *stool*; **storm**, *storm*; **strēam**, *stream*; **torn**, *grief*; **þanc**, *thought*; **þēof**, *thief*; **þorp**, **þrop**, *farm, village*; **weg**, *way*; **wer**, *man*; **wulf**, *wolf*.

See § **259** on nouns whose stems ended in double consonants: **bucc**, *buck*; **cocc**, *cock*; **codd**, *cod, husk*; **coss**, *kiss*; **cnoll**, *knoll*; **cropp**, *sprout*; **hnæpp**, *cup*; **hwamm**, *corner*; **pott**, *pot*; **sceatt**, *property, money*; **smocc**, *smock*; **swamm**, *fungus*; **weall**, *wall*.

§ **336.** Like **dæg** are declined **pæþ**, *path*; **stæf**, *staff*; **hwæl**, *whale*, see §§ **54, 57.** **mǣg**, *kinsman*, pl. **mǣgas** (§ **120**) beside **mǣgas** with **ǣ** from the singular.

§ **337.** Like **mearh** are declined **ealh**, *temple*; **eolh**, *elk*; **fearh**, *pig, boar*; **healh**, *corner*; **sealh**, *willow*; **seolh**, *seal* (*animal*); **wealh**, *foreigner*, see § **149.** **scōh**, *shoe*, gen. **scōs**, dat. **scō**, pl. **scōs**, see § **139**; and similarly **slōh** (also fem. and neut.), *slough, mire*; **eoh** (also neut.), *horse*, gen. **eōs**, dat. **ēo.** **horh** (also neut.), *dirt*, gen. **horwes**, dat. **horwe**, beside **hōres, hōre**; pl. **horwu** (neut.) beside **hōras**, see § **239.**

§ **338.** SING.

Nom. Acc.	**cyning**, *king*	**engel**, *angel*	**heofon**, *heaven*
Gen.	**cyninges**	**engles**	**heofones**
Dat.	**cyninge**	**engle**	**heofone**